SDS 4135 - Project 4

Due November 8

Daylight Savings Time and Fatal Crashes

There is ongoing debate on whether the United States should continue with its current practice of moving clocks one hour ahead in early March and one hour back in early November, in other words to observe "daylight savings time' ' during the middle of the year. The U.S.
House of Representatives has passed a bill to place the country on permanent daylight savings time, while others propose we switch to permanent standard time, which means not altering the clocks at all.

Your task in this project is to produce a statistical analyses that attempts to answer the question, "What is the effect of daylight savings on traffic fatalities in the U.S.?" The challenge here is that we have not run controlled experiments, so we must try to answer the question using observational data.

You have been provided with a dataset called "fars.RData' ', which has 10 years of data from the Fatality Analysis Reporting System, a National Highway Traffic Safety Administration program for collecting fatal accident reports into a national database. The data go back to 1975; additional data beyond the 10 years provided can be found here:

https://www.nhtsa.gov/file-downloads?p=nhtsa/downloads/FARS/

You may use this dataset or any external datasets to help answer the project question. In additional to the project question, your group should propose another interesting question and attempt to answer it using a statistical analysis.